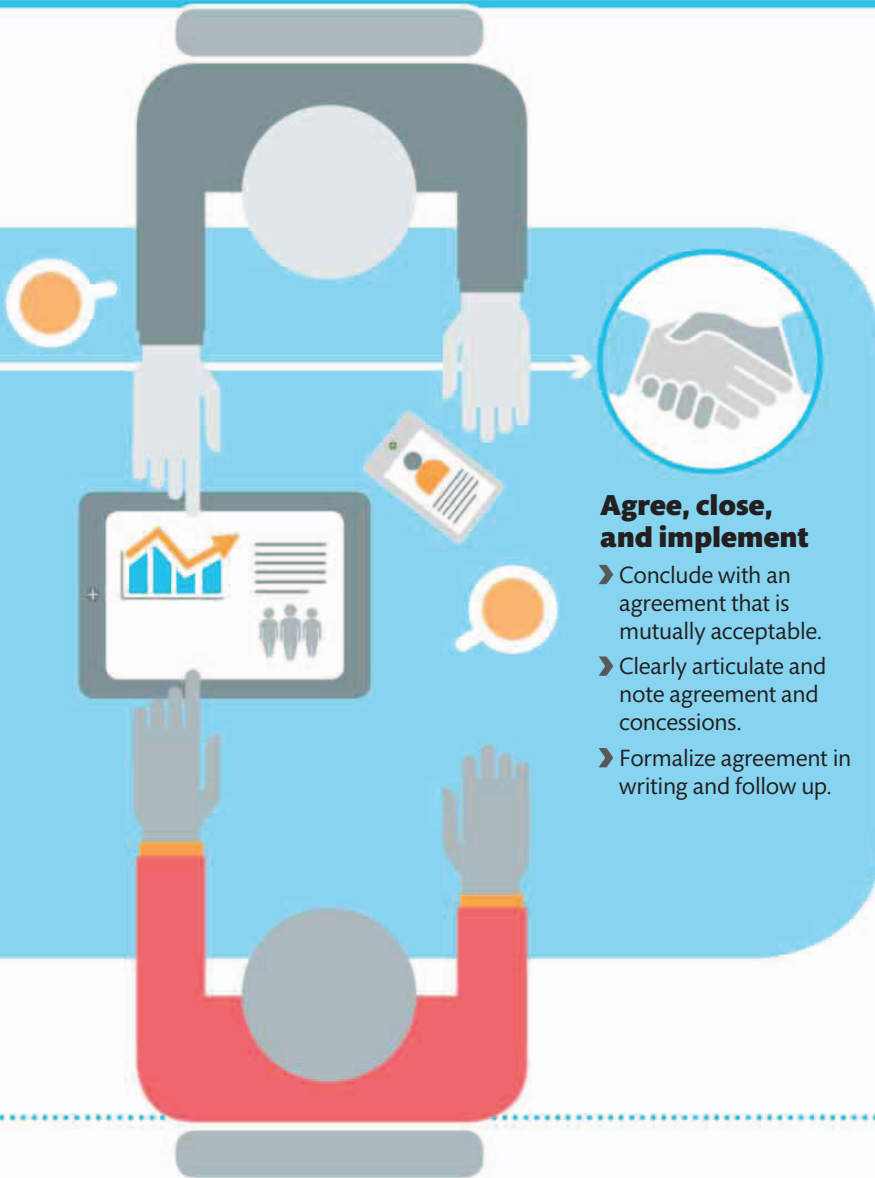




65%
of face-to-face communication
is through non-verbal signals



BODY LANGUAGE IN DIFFERENT CULTURES

With international negotiations, it can be hard to read body language signals, particularly since the meaning of gestures can vary.



Eye contact Chinese people avoid direct eye contact to show respect while American people see lack of eye contact as a sign of shiftiness.



Facial expressions When emotions are high in the US, it is acceptable to frown, even to swear, but not to cry. Japanese people might smile or laugh, but never frown or cry.



Head movements In much of Europe and the US, people nod to mean yes and shake their head to mean no. But in some parts of the world, such as in Bulgaria, it is the opposite way round.



Gestures Western cultures use a hand extended towards a person to indicate "Come here". Chinese people would see this gesture as offensive.



Posture In the US, being casual is valued; people might slouch when standing or sitting. In some European countries, such as Germany, a slouching posture is considered rude. Formality is also valued in Japan, particularly the ability to sit upright and still.